



POSITION DESCRIPTION

WNA Board Member Board Chair

Lead Member • One Year • V3

AT A GLANCE

ROLE TYPE Supervisor role	TIME COMMITMENT 6 hrs /week
TERM One Year	LOCATION All Meetings / Events

The Board Chair role description includes your responsibilities as Board Chair, including agenda setting, meeting facilitation, Oregon nonprofit compliance, and notices.

Overview

Position Description

As Board Chair, or board president, you are responsible for many important association responsibilities both during and between meetings. These responsibilities include but are not limited to: responding to public inquiries, facilitating meetings, team-building, board member accountability, teaching new board members their roles.

This packet contains a description of your role as Board Chair and resources to aid you in the process.

Responsibilities

Leadership

Neighborhood associations exist for community outreach; as Board Chair, you should be approachable, available, and active in the community. Take the initiative! Cultivate relationships among board members, keep a healthy work environment for the board, and hold everyone accountable for their responsibilities. Neighborhood associations are volunteer driven, and it is your responsibility to keep the board connected and active.

Agenda setting and notification

You will prepare the associating meeting agendas for general, board, and special meetings. You are also responsible for using proper notification protocols once meeting agendas and any additional documents are prepared.

Here are some resources for setting agendas and notification requirements:

- [Tips for Preparing a Successful Agenda](#)
- [Sample Agenda](#)
- [Notification Requirements](#)

Meeting facilitation

You will conduct effective, productive, accessible, and welcoming board meetings. Guide discussions to stay on topic, encourage participation, and follow [association bylaws](#).

[Here is the overview for meeting facilitation.](#)

Agenda Setting

A successful meeting only happens if you have a successful agenda. As Board Chair, you are responsible for taking board input and using your own judgement to create meeting agendas. The agenda is a time-tracker, an outline, and a guide to facilitating a success meeting.

OUTLINE FOR AGENDA SETTING

An agenda is a way to communicate the elements and topics of a meeting. Typically, a meeting will have items that occur in every meeting, called “general business” or “standing items”, and items that change depending on community interests and concerns. Here is an agenda outline for a Woodlawn Neighborhood Association (WNA) general meeting:

Before beginning an agenda, consider the date, time, and location of the meeting. Utilize our [meeting minutes template](#) and fill out the relevant metadata.

General business

WNA meetings typically frontload community projects and involvement to respect the time of community attendees. Board business is saved for the end of the meeting as it doesn't involve the community as directly, and can occasionally go over the allotted time for a meeting.

1. Standing Items

- a. Welcome and introductions: WNA meetings usually start with a round 10 minutes of introductions. This allows attendees to meet the board and one another. Everyone at the meeting should have the opportunity to introduce themselves. This time also allows attendees to filter in late without disrupting more significant portions of the meeting.
 - i. Greet newcomers and have everyone introduce themselves at every meeting.
 - ii. Consider posing icebreaker questions like, ‘where are you from, where do you live, where do you work?’.
 - iii. Introductions are always optional, signify this to the meeting.
- b. Ground Rules and Voting Procedures: explaining voting procedures and setting ground rules keeps attendees informed and the meeting running smoothly.
 - i. You determine the degree of participation at meetings. All WNA meetings

must be observable and open to public viewing. [Here](#) is our process for running hybrid WNA meetings.

- c. Approval of Agenda and Past Minutes: The board should approve the meeting agenda and past meeting minutes.
 - i. Provide an overview of the agenda to attendees and offer justification for any changes or additions.
 - ii. Motion for the board to approve the meeting agenda.
 - iii. Ask for any further revisions to past minutes and seek a motion to approve the meeting minutes.
2. Community Items
- a. Board Positions (as needed): If there are any board seats that remain unfilled, or any board positions that are due to change, provide information about the roles or respective changes.
 - i. Need more information about how we approve and select board positions.
 - b. Community Projects: Allocate time to discuss any current projects that the board is working on, or community projects that directly involve the board. If community members are running events, allow them to present.
 - i. Try to time every section of agendas minute by minute, which will change depending on community activity. Keep summaries as short as possible.
 - ii. Always provide ways for community members to contribute to projects. This can be word of mouth, online sign-up sheets, or physical volunteer sheets.
 - c. Open Comments and Concerns: Reserve some time at the end of 'general business' for open comments, where any community member can have the floor to discuss any concerns they may have.
 - i. Best practice is to have community members reach out to you in advance about concerns they would like to bring up as to adjust the time needed for this section accordingly.

Board business

WNA meetings save the organizational board elements of a meeting for the end, and they are completely optional for community attendees. Board business is important to keep the

board aligned in their goals, aware of their progress, and organized.

3. Board Reports: These are the bulk of board business. They are integral to the sharing of information about the board and its progress.
 - a. Allocate minutes for each board position to give their monthly report.
 - b. The board positions are:
 - i. Treasurer
 - ii. Farmer's Market Rep
 - iii. Secretary
 - iv. Outreach and Community Engagement
 - v. Land Use and Transportation
 - vi. Board Chair
4. Final Topics and Future Meetings: This time is for any final comments. Usually these are reminders about upcoming events, meetings, potential financial deadlines, or upcoming plans.
 - a. If applicable, you can also use this term to briefly discuss what topics will be brought up at the next WNA meeting.

The key to meeting facilitation is keeping meetings on time, on task, and on the same page. Facilitation takes time and practice, and every Board Chair has their own style and organization. Frequently ask for feedback and suggestions from your fellow board members and attendees to find ways to improve your meetings. Meetings that run on time and are effective will help the WNA make decisions, and show that you respect the time and energy of everyone involved.

8 Tips for Meeting Facilitation

BE PREPARED

Plan the agenda and make sure notice has gone out at least one week prior to the meeting. Contact presenters to make sure they will be attending. Reach out to fellow board members to ensure that all tasks are covered and everyone understands their specific roles/responsibilities.

KNOW YOUR GROUND RULES

Always state ground rules at the beginning of meetings. This is both to remind your board and general membership. Your meeting has a better chance of running smoothly if everyone understands the way the meeting will be run, what will be tolerated, and what won't.

FACILITATE VOTING AND DEISION-MAKING

Never assume an agreement has been reached without a vote. The Board Chair should review how voting works when needed during meetings. Make sure people know who is allowed to vote at the beginning of meetings.

STAY ON TIME

It is often helpful to assign the role of timekeeper to another board member so that time will be better monitored. Remember, your agenda should be written minute-by-minute, so you can refer to it during the meeting to enforce strict time limits on topics.

DIRECT THE DISCUSSION AND STAY ON TOPIC

If information is being repeated in a meeting, or is getting off topic, recap the information and realign the meeting. If a decision needs to be made, call for a motion from the group.

ALWAYS MAINTAIN YOUR ROLE AS BOARD CHAIR

Facilitate group discussions, making sure all are being heard. Part of your responsibility, however, is not to abuse your position or monopolize your time on the floor.

WRAP-UP AT THE END OF THE MEETING

Briefly review all key decisions made and restate action items. Don't forget to acknowledge any new faces in the room and remind them to sign in (and up for the newsletter!).

FOLLOW-UP AFTER THE MEETING

Offer help to other board members as needed and make a plan for connecting with any new members.

To make a motion:

Say “I move to...”

To amend a motion:

Say “I move to amend the motion on the floor”

To refer a topic to a committee:

Say “I move we refer this matter to [committee name]”

To table until a future meeting:

Say “I move that we table...”

Questions? Email info@gowoodlawn.com